Macintosh Mini

Setup guide

Your Mini is built and ready. Setting it up takes about ten minutes, using your phone.

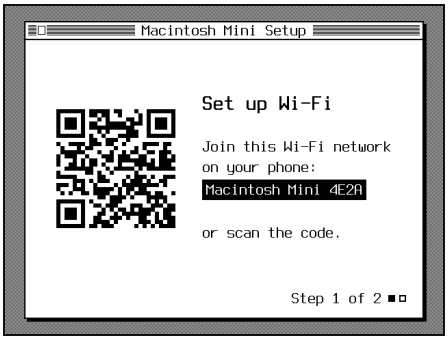
Before you start

Your Wi-Fi name and password
The Mini needs 2.4 GHz Wi-Fi, which almost every home router has.

Your phone
And a computer, if your ROM is on it.

A Mac ROM file
Every Mac needs Apple's startup code, its ROM. It isn't included, because Apple still owns it. Redundant Robot's emulator guide explains which one to use and where to find it. The **Performa ROM** works best.
`redundantrobot.com/sheepshaver`

Step 1 of 2



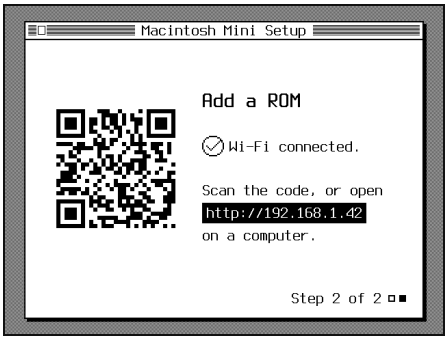
What the Mini shows

Wi-Fi, from your phone

1. Push the floppy disk into its slot to turn the Mini on. After a moment it shows **Set up Wi-Fi**.
2. On your phone, join the Wi-Fi network it names, **Macintosh Mini** and four letters and numbers, or scan its code with your phone's camera.
3. A setup page opens by itself. If it doesn't, open `10.42.0.1` in your browser.
4. Choose your Wi-Fi network and type its password.
5. Choose a password for the Mini and type it twice. You'll only need it for advanced things, like copying files onto it. Write it in the box below.
6. Tap **Connect**. The Mini joins your Wi-Fi, and your phone goes back to it.

If the Mini says **Couldn't join**, check the Wi-Fi password, then join Macintosh Mini again and have another go.

Step 2 of 2



Your address will be different

Add a ROM

1. Scan the code on the Mini's screen with your phone, or type the address it shows into a browser on a computer on the same Wi-Fi.
2. Upload your ROM file (or the .zip it came in), or paste its download link.
3. The Mini checks it and starts Mac OS. Listen for the chime!

If the Mini comes back to **Add a ROM**, that ROM didn't work. Reload the page and try another.

Your Mini

Name `macintosh-mini-` **Username** `mac`

Address _____ **Password** _____

The name ends in the four letters and numbers from its Wi-Fi network, in lower case. The address is the one on the Add a ROM screen.

Using your Mini

Everyday use

Floppy disk	Push it in to turn the Mini on. Pull it out to turn it off, once it has shut down.
Right button	Shuts down. Give it about 20 seconds, then pull out the floppy.
Left button	Press to restart Mac OS. Hold for 10 seconds to join a different Wi-Fi network (step 1 again; press it once more to cancel).
Dial	Brightness.
USB-C	Charges the battery. The Mini runs on battery or plugged in.

At night

The screen dims after sunset and turns off late at night. Turn the dial to wake it.

Keyboard and mouse

The Mini works as a desk clock and screen saver on its own. To use Mac OS, plug a USB keyboard and mouse into the port on the back, if yours has one. A small USB hub lets you use both.

What's on it

Mac OS 8.1 from 1998, set up and ready:

- **iCab** and **MR Browser** for the web. Most of today's sites are too much for a '90s Mac, so iCab opens a page of ones that work: FrogFind, 68k.news and Macintosh Repository.
- **After Dark**: flying toasters and friends after 5 minutes.
- **Big Maclock**: a big desk clock.
- **StuffIt Expander** and **Disk Copy**, to open old Mac downloads.
- Printing to an AppleTalk ImageWriter, like an AirWriter.

From a computer

Under Mac OS, the Mini runs Raspberry Pi OS. You can reach it from a computer on the same Wi-Fi with the name, username and password from page 1. If the name doesn't work, use the address.

Log in (SSH)

In Terminal (PowerShell on Windows), type this with your Mini's name:

```
ssh mac@macintosh-mini-xxxx.local
```

Copy files (SFTP)

Use an app like Cyberduck, FileZilla or Transmit. Choose **SFTP**, not FTP, then enter the Mini's name, the username **mac** and your password. Your files are in its home folder.

Use a different disk image

Copy it into the home folder, then delete the old one. (Copy the old one to your computer first if there's anything on it you want to keep.) Press the left button and the Mini starts from the new disk. It takes .hda, .dsk, .img and .hfv disks with System 7.5 to Mac OS 8.1. The original is at `archive.org/details/macos-8.1-basilisk-ii`

Get updates

Log in and run the installer. It keeps your Wi-Fi, ROM and disk:

```
curl -fsSL https://raw.githubusercontent.com/
wr/macintosh-mini/main/setup.sh | bash
```

Something not right?

Moved, or got new Wi-Fi? Hold the left button for 10 seconds and do step 1 again. The Mini remembers your old network too.

Mac OS froze? Press the left button to restart it.

Can't find the Mini by name? Some routers block names ending in .local. Use its address, or look for `macintosh-mini` in your router's list of devices.

A soft hum on battery? That's normal for this board, and quieter with the brightness turned down.

Build guide and help
`wells.ee/projects/macintosh-mini`
Questions: `github.com/wr/macintosh-mini/issues`

Macintosh Mini by Wells Workshop
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